

Prahl Portfolio Work Log - August 10, 2026 (Part 2)

Compiled summary for Monday, August 10, 2026 - Part 2 - focus: continuing the PrahL.dev Portfolio Alla Vostra UI Foundations Visual Hierarchy section after the August 10 Part 1 framed-startup pass, forcing Visual Hierarchy stacks below the category copy, building custom curly-brace annotation geometry, adding right-side section callout lines and green eyebrow labels, adding Step 3 and Step 4 home-screen device-frame examples, rebuilding no-island and muted mockup assets with matching device-frame depth order, scaling the four Visual Hierarchy stacks into a compact two-by-two layout, adding PRE-SCROLLING and ON-SCROLLING row headers centered between the stack pairs, validating TypeScript and browser-rendered geometry, refreshing the Portfolio project snapshot, reviewing all prior Portfolio PDF worklogs, and generating the August 10 Part 2 Portfolio PDF worklog. Generated in continuity with the established Prahl Portfolio daily worklog cadence: compact opening summary, source-material section, baseline section, goal list, work-completed sections, validation section, files-touched list, follow-up context, and output-artifact close.

This artifact intentionally covers Prahl/portfolio work performed after portfolio_worklog_august10_part1.pdf and after the August 10 Part 1 documentation state. The committed source state reviewed for this record is 6de20a9e44e2f23d6ac265d82d6269628aad5602 on main, matching origin/main before this PDF was generated. That commit already contains the Visual Hierarchy source and asset work described here. This PDF and the refreshed project snapshot are the new documentation artifacts produced for the August 10 Part 2 record before the requested public-site push/deployment verification pass.

Source Materials Reviewed

- Ran ./read_project.sh from /Users/prahlin/gh/portfolio and regenerated portfolio_PROJECT_SNAPSHOT.txt before writing this worklog, preserving the project convention that Codex refreshes the current source snapshot before continuing Portfolio documentation work.
- Reviewed the refreshed portfolio_PROJECT_SNAPSHOT.txt, including project notes, source tree, public image and font inventories, PDF worklog inventory, package and deployment configuration, git context, recent commits, and the standing instruction to ask for a commit message before committing or pushing.
- Reviewed every pre-existing Portfolio root-level worklog PDF:
portfolio_worklog_july11.pdf, portfolio_worklog_july14.pdf,
portfolio_worklog_july15_part1.pdf, portfolio_worklog_july15_part2.pdf,
portfolio_worklog_july16.pdf, portfolio_worklog_july19.pdf,
portfolio_worklog_july20.pdf, portfolio_worklog_july21.pdf,
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portfolio_worklog_july31.pdf, portfolio_worklog_august1_part1.pdf,
portfolio_worklog_august1_part2.pdf, portfolio_worklog_august1_part3.pdf,
portfolio_worklog_august3.pdf, portfolio_worklog_august4.pdf,
portfolio_worklog_august5.pdf, portfolio_worklog_august6.pdf, and
portfolio_worklog_august10_part1.pdf.
- Extracted text from all twenty-three existing Portfolio PDFs with pdftotext and checked recent metadata with pdfinfo to preserve title cadence, Part 2 naming, opening-summary density, section order, compact bullet-heavy technical voice, validation language, files-touched lists, follow-up context, output-artifact close, root-level filename style, letter-size pages, PDF 1.4 output, Codex author/creator/producer metadata, and Helvetica-style base-font convention.
- Used portfolio_worklog_august10_part1.pdf as the closest same-day structural baseline because it documented the first Visual Hierarchy startup-frame pass, the framed-device scale language, lower-muted Focal Point treatment, TT Fors annotations, local browser measurement workflow, and local-only deployment wording.

- Reviewed git history through git log, git show --stat, git show --name-status, git status, git diff --stat, and git diff --check. HEAD and origin/main resolved to 6de20a9 before this PDF was generated.
- Reviewed app/projects/alla-vostra/ProductFlowSwitcher.tsx, app/globals.css, public/images/alla-vostra-hero-startup-framed-no-island.png, public/images/alla-vostra-hero-startup-framed-lower-muted-no-island.png, public/images/alla-vostra-home-framed-no-island.png, public/images/alla-vostra-home-framed-toolbar-nav-muted-no-island.png, the Visual Hierarchy brace SVG assets, package scripts, the Hostinger static-export workflow, and the local route at /projects/alla-vostra.

Baseline Status Before August 10 Part 2 Work

- August 10 Part 1 had already established real framed startup-device screenshots for Visual Hierarchy Step 1 and Step 2, including Viewing Area and Focal Point TT Fors annotations and a lower-muted focal-point asset.
- The Visual Hierarchy section still needed a stronger system explanation across more than two examples. Steps 3 and 4 were not yet populated with home-screen device-frame examples, and the user wanted the section to read as a complete design-system breakdown rather than a partially filled placeholder set.
- The Visual Hierarchy category originally sat in a wide grid where Step 1 and Step 2 could appear alongside the category copy. The user wanted all device-frame/screenshot stacks to start on a new row beneath the Visual Hierarchy title and description before later requesting a compact two-stack-per-row arrangement.
- The early annotation approach relied on text overlays inside the framed screenshots. The user wanted external brace-and-label systems that could point at regions of the app UI without covering the screenshots themselves.
- Step 3 and Step 4 needed to use home_screen_large.png inside the same accepted device frame and depth order as Steps 1 and 2, including corrected no-island top treatment and matching hardware-over-screen compositing.
- The right-side white section lines and green eyebrow labels needed to identify precise UI zones, then remain aligned while line widths, device-frame order, row scaling, and grid placement changed through the design pass.
- The local Next.js dev server repeatedly held stale CSS and optimized image output after rapid asset/CSS iteration, so cache clears and dev-server restarts remained part of the verification baseline.

Goals for August 10 Part 2

- Force the Visual Hierarchy screenshot stacks to sit below the category header and description whenever the section is in its expanded UI Foundations layout.
- Replace the in-device text-only hierarchy labels with custom external curly-brace systems that preserve a thin flow-diagram look, left-side placement, jagged or smoothed center tips as requested, and consistent black/white stroke treatment.
- Add right-side section lines and green eyebrow labels for app header, navigation bar, hero, main content, shopping cart, toolbar, and related Step-specific regions using vertical-center logic from the real screenshots.
- Populate Step 3 and Step 4 with home-screen framed screenshots that use the same device frame, no-island top treatment, and screenshot-under-frame depth order as Steps 1 and 2.
- Build Step 4 as a gray-out mockup for toolbar/navigation emphasis while keeping main content, cart button, bottom bar, and hardware frame outside the outdated rounding mask.
- Save accepted curly-brace variants as reusable SVG reference assets for future Visual Hierarchy work.
- Compact the finished Visual Hierarchy sequence by scaling Steps 1 through 4 as whole stacks to 50 percent and arranging them as Step 1 plus Step 2 on row one and Step 3 plus Step 4 on row two.
- Add row headers PRE-SCROLLING and ON-SCROLLING centered horizontally between the pair of

stacks in each row, then validate the actual rendered centers in the browser.

Work Completed - Visual Hierarchy Layout and Stack Flow

- Added a Visual-Hierarchy-specific full-row capture group so the category header and body span the full layout width, preventing Step 1 and Step 2 from sitting beside the Visual Hierarchy copy in wide aspect ratios.
- Later restored a two-column Visual Hierarchy grid after the stack scale changed, keeping the category copy above the grid while arranging the four active steps as a 2x2 matrix.
- Limited the Visual Hierarchy sequence to Steps 1 through 4 for the visible documentation set, removing the old Show More break for this category while leaving other UI Foundations categories on their established expansion behavior.
- Added a visibleStepLimit hook to PlaceholderStage so Visual Hierarchy could request four visible steps without changing the default two-step or narrow-layout behavior for other sections.
- Scaled each Visual Hierarchy Step 1 through Step 4 stack to 50 percent as a complete unit with CSS zoom, preserving internal relationships among the Step header, screenshot, brace, brace text, section lines, green labels, and caption.
- Added PRE-SCROLLING and ON-SCROLLING row labels, then corrected them so each label is horizontally centered in the gap between the two stacks in its row rather than centered over either individual stack.

Work Completed - Brace Geometry and Annotation System

- Extended PlaceholderScreen with reusable Visual Hierarchy brace support, external annotation placement, optional extra brace stacks, configurable brace paths, section-line callout arrays, and braced frame-pair wrapping.
- Built the first custom full-height left-side curly brace for Viewing Area, iterating through the requested thin noodle-like look, left-of-device placement, smoother top and bottom transitions, sharper center bump, doubled stroke thickness, and unclipped pointed tip.
- Reused the accepted Step 2 brace language for Step 1 so both main Viewing Area examples shared the same white-with-black-stroke visual treatment.
- Created a 50 percent compressed brace variant for Step 2 Focal Point and a matching lower-half Supporting Elements brace, preserving the same curvature language while shortening the long vertical runs.
- Added 10 percent and 90 percent Step 4 brace variants, then smoothed the 10 percent Supporting Elements tip after the user approved de-jagging that compact top brace.
- Saved reusable SVG reference assets for the full, 50 percent, 10 percent, and 90 percent white/black brace variants under public/images/alla-vostra/.
- Kept brace widths fixed so the braces do not resize independently during window widening or compression, preserving the accepted optical thickness and relative spacing.

Work Completed - Section Lines and Eyebrow Labels

- Added right-side white line callouts that match the brace stroke thickness and run outward from the device frame at each annotated section center.
- Moved the green Step eyebrow labels from above the device frames to the right side of the new white lines, renamed them APP HEADER, NAV BAR, HERO, TOOLBAR, MAIN CONTENT, and SHOPPING CART according to the active step context, and scaled them up to the requested prominence.
- Calculated Step 1 and Step 2 callouts for the orange app header, white navigation bar, hero image, main content area, and shopping cart region, using the table area rather than the cheeseboard where the user corrected the boundary.
- Added Step 3 and Step 4 callout sets for toolbar, nav bar, main content, and shopping cart on the home-screen screenshot assets.
- Moved MAIN CONTENT and SHOPPING CART callouts from the focal-point stack to the Step 1 stack when the user clarified the hierarchy grouping.

- Shortened all right-side connector lines from 100px to 50px while keeping the green labels anchored to the new line end and preserving the same post-line label gap.
- Validated that the scaled two-by-two grid reduces the rendered connector-line width to 25px as part of the complete 50 percent stack scale while retaining the 50px source rule.

Work Completed - Step 3 and Step 4 Home-Screen Assets

- Generated public/images/alla-vostra-home-framed.png as the first home-screen framed derivative, then replaced the active Visual Hierarchy usage with no-island variants after the user asked to remove the awkward top rounded rectangle/dynamic-island obstruction.
- Added public/images/alla-vostra-home-framed-no-island.png for Step 3 and public/images/alla-vostra-home-framed-toolbar-nav-muted-no-island.png for Step 4.
- Rebuilt Step 3 and Step 4 home-screen mockups from home_screen_large.png using the same 1290 x 2661 device-frame canvas, screenshot scale, crop, no-island top treatment, and frame-over-screenshot depth order as the Step 1 and Step 2 startup assets.
- Generated no-island startup variants for Step 1 and Step 2 so the Visual Hierarchy examples share the same unobstructed app-header treatment.
- Rebuilt the Step 4 muted mockup so only the toolbar and nav bar are dimmed while main content, shopping cart, bottom native bar, and the hardware frame remain fully opaque.
- Corrected the Step 4 gray-out region after it followed outdated corner-rounding behavior by muting the final framed image and preserving frame pixels over the muted band.
- Verified alpha samples in the generated assets so toolbar/nav pixels use 50 percent opacity where intended while frame corners, main content, cart button, and lower device frame remain fully opaque.

Work Completed - Browser Validation and Cache Handling

- Repeatedly cleared .next/cache and .next/dev/cache after stale optimized images or stale CSS rules caused the browser to show old Visual Hierarchy widths, old line lengths, or old layout behavior.
- Restarted the local Next.js dev server on http://127.0.0.1:3000 after stale Turbopack CSS bundles omitted newly added Visual Hierarchy selectors.
- Used Playwright to switch into UI Foundations, locate the Visual Hierarchy section, expand or inspect the rendered stacks, and measure frame width, stack zoom, line width, row count, label text, row-header centers, and image URLs.
- Confirmed the final Visual Hierarchy grid renders four visible stacks, two columns, no category-specific Show More button, 50 percent stack zoom, 159px rendered device-frame width, and row-header centers aligned to the gap between stack pairs.
- Captured temporary browser screenshots during the device-frame, muted-image, row-scaling, connector-line, and row-label passes to compare the rendered page against the user-provided visual direction.
- Ran npm run check after the major JSX/CSS passes and after the final row-label adjustment, confirming TypeScript passed with tsc --noEmit.

Work Completed - Commit and Documentation Context

- Recommended a commit message in the requested one-header plus hyphen-line format, covering the Visual Hierarchy stack rendering, no-island framed assets, muted Step 4 mockup, saved brace SVGs, section callouts, 50 percent scale, and row headers.
- The current source work was committed as 6de20a9, Refined Alla Vostra Visual Hierarchy stacks, with app/globals.css, app/projects/alla-vostra/ProductFlowSwitcher.tsx, generated PNG assets, and brace SVG reference assets included.
- Confirmed after that commit that main and origin/main matched at 6de20a9 before beginning the August 10 Part 2 worklog-generation task.
- Regenerated portfolio_PROJECT_SNAPSHOT.txt for the current project state before this PDF was written, then used the refreshed snapshot and all prior worklogs as source material

for this August 10 Part 2 record.

Validation Summary

- npm run check passed with tsc --noEmit after the Visual Hierarchy row scaling and row-header work, and again during the August 10 Part 2 worklog-generation pass.
- Playwright confirmed the Visual Hierarchy section has four visible stacks, grid columns of approximately 573px and 573px on a 1440px viewport, no Visual Hierarchy Show More button, and Step 1 through Step 4 rendered at zoom 0.5.
- Playwright confirmed the rendered device frames scale from the 318px source width to 159px inside the final compact grid.
- Playwright confirmed PRE-SCROLLING and ON-SCROLLING render in white and center at the horizontal gap between Step 1/Step 2 and Step 3/Step 4 respectively.
- Browser measurements confirmed right-side connector lines use the shortened 50px source width before stack scaling and render proportionally within the scaled Visual Hierarchy stacks.
- Pixel checks confirmed Step 4 toolbar and nav pixels were muted while the current hardware frame, corners, main content, cart button, and bottom frame remain fully opaque.
- Static export was not rerun before this PDF was drafted because the source Visual Hierarchy commit was already pushed to origin/main; a final build/push/deployment verification pass follows this documentation artifact at the user request.

Files Touched

- app/projects/alla-vostra/ProductFlowSwitcher.tsx - extended the screenshot placeholder/rendering system with Visual Hierarchy brace stacks, section-line callouts, row labels, four-step visible layout support, no-island framed image sources, Step 3/4 home-screen examples, and Step 4 brace split configuration.
- app/globals.css - added Visual Hierarchy frame-pair geometry, fixed brace sizing, white/black brace strokes, section-line styling, shortened connector widths, full-row category layout, two-column compact grid behavior, 50 percent stack scaling, and centered row-header positioning.
- public/images/alla-vostra-hero-startup-framed-no-island.png - added the clean startup framed image used by Visual Hierarchy Step 1.
- public/images/alla-vostra-hero-startup-framed-lower-muted-no-island.png - added the Step 2 no-island lower-muted startup focal-point image.
- public/images/alla-vostra-home-framed.png - added the first generated home-screen framed derivative for future/reference use.
- public/images/alla-vostra-home-framed-no-island.png - added the Step 3 home-screen framed image with matching device-frame depth order.
- public/images/alla-vostra-home-framed-toolbar-nav-muted-no-island.png - added the Step 4 home-screen framed image with toolbar/nav muted and the updated current frame boundary preserved.
- public/images/alla-vostra/visual-hierarchy-brace-white-black.svg, visual-hierarchy-brace-white-black-50.svg, visual-hierarchy-brace-white-black-10.svg, and visual-hierarchy-brace-white-black-90.svg - added reusable brace reference assets for the accepted full, half, 10 percent, and 90 percent variants.
- portfolio_PROJECT_SNAPSHOT.txt - regenerated to reflect the current source tree, recent source commit, public image inventory, PDF inventory, and documentation context.
- portfolio_worklog_august10_part2.pdf - generated this new root-level PDF worklog artifact following the existing Portfolio naming, style, metadata, and structure conventions.

Follow-Up Context

- The Visual Hierarchy section now uses a compact explanatory grid rather than the earlier full-size one-stack-per-row inspection layout. Future additions should account for the

50 percent stack scale before changing line lengths or brace text sizes.

- The generated no-island and muted PNGs are derived assets. If the base device frame, source screenshot crop, or home/startup screen source changes, the derivative assets should be regenerated together so Steps 1 through 4 remain synchronized.
- The saved brace SVGs are reference files only; the live page still renders brace paths from ProductFlowSwitcher constants so interactive layout changes can keep the same geometry without loading separate SVG files.
- The local Next.js dev workflow showed stale CSS/image behavior during rapid iteration. Future visual passes should continue clearing .next caches and restarting the dev server when browser measurements do not match the current source.
- The Hostinger deployment path remains the GitHub Actions static-export workflow on pushes to main, publishing the out/ directory to the hostinger-deploy branch.

Output Artifact

- Generated: /Users/prahlin/gh/portfolio/portfolio_worklog_august10_part2.pdf
- Companion sync file: /Users/prahlin/gh/portfolio/portfolio_PROJECT_SNAPSHOT.txt
- Next requested action after this PDF: commit/push the documentation artifact and refreshed snapshot, then confirm the public prahl.dev deployment path completes successfully.